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Rev. Edward F. Casey

Only after dinner that day was I informed that Fr. Sol. was supposed to give the sermon of the jubilee solemnity. Luckily my next neighbor at table had asked me a week or so before: "Did you get an invitation to preach the jubilee sermon?", and remembering my surprise the morning before the Golden Jubilee in Seattle, by the announcement in church that "Father Bernard will give the sermon", I did not mind the task, having thought things over what to say. In fact I felt it quit a privilege even to get back again into the old pulpit that I had not seen for near fifteen years, and to address old friends & new.

Well the jubilee passed, as do all things temporal, and seemingly everyone was satisfied as to its impressiveness, etc. Just one in all concerned was not exactly satisfied that I knew, but neither did he complain. Rather he thanked God that it went as well as it did and hoped he might do better another time. Besides friends from Yonkers and Harlem and Brooklyn, etc., two of our cousins - nuns from Waltham, Mass., were at the Solemn Mass that day. The following days the Rev. brothers visited the brethren and friends together in East New York, Harlem, Yonkers, Hoboken, N.J., etc. We went also to see Thomas Ford of the Irish World. He is the only survivor of the sons of the great founder that old beacon-light of culture - of patriotism at once and of religion. I knew them all in former years together with their still surviving sister. He seemed pleased at our call. Friday noon I went to Albany and thence by bus to some friends in Watervleit just across from Troy. They took me back to Albany for the night "Wolverine" and that reached Detroit about 7 a.m. Saturday, Deo Grat!

Of course I need not inform you of the Provincial Chapter and the many changes that followed. One of these was that Fr. M.E.J. was transferred to Marathon, Wis. After stoping here a few days on the way thither, and a few weeks in the new - St. Anthony Monastery - he seems to have quite enjoyed a week or so vacation. This he spent mostly visiting old friends, and scenes of long ago -- in the majority of cases of course, not the same as painted on memory's canvas. Well, if they only reminded him of ups and downs of our innocent days, congratulations. In a way I think I would like to have been with him; Though as a rule it suffices me to think back and consider the lonesome changes that were taking place in old Trimbelle even before we left, and that I know to have taken place since, both there and about the Mt. St. Helen Home - the little green garden of the Saint Croix Valley. It suffices me, I wanted to say, to think of these changes by the hand of time and after the dear Angel of death, to lift my longings of heart and soul from such days "and dreamings never more to be", and to focus them again and again on ideals that are not "wrecked on the shores of the real", and neither, sleep like a dream in a grave".